

Priority Five

Economic Opportunity & Local Businesses

"A thriving local economy creates opportunity for every resident, strengthens our neighborhoods, and secures the future of our City."

Why This Matters

A strong local economy benefits everyone.

When businesses succeed...

Families have greater opportunities.

Residents have access to better jobs.

Shopping centers become vibrant gathering places.

City revenues grow without placing additional burdens on taxpayers.

Those additional revenues allow us to improve public safety, repair roads, invest in our parks, strengthen neighborhood services, and enhance the quality of life throughout West Covina.

Economic development is not simply about attracting new businesses.

It is about creating an environment where entrepreneurs, employers, restaurants, retailers, and local businesses want to invest because they believe in our community.

As someone who owned and operated a small business for nearly fifteen years, I understand the risks, sacrifices, and determination required to build something from the ground up.

I've experienced the challenges of managing employees, balancing budgets, serving customers, complying with regulations, and making payroll.

Those experiences gave me a deep appreciation for the vital role small businesses play in creating jobs, supporting families, and strengthening communities.

Our businesses are not simply taxpayers.

They are our partners.

When local businesses succeed, West Covina succeeds.

As Your Councilmember, I Will Advocate For:

Supporting Small Businesses

- Support existing businesses by listening to their concerns and reducing unnecessary barriers.
- Promote a business-friendly City Hall that values collaboration and customer service.
- Encourage streamlined permitting and licensing processes whenever possible.
- Strengthen communication between City Hall and our local business community.
- Recognize and celebrate the businesses that invest in West Covina.

Revitalizing Commercial Corridors

Every neighborhood deserves vibrant shopping centers that residents are proud to visit.

I will work to:

- Encourage responsible redevelopment of aging commercial properties.
- Attract restaurants, retailers, and businesses that complement our community.
- Reduce long-term commercial vacancies whenever possible.
- Improve the appearance and accessibility of our business districts.
- Promote redevelopment that respects surrounding neighborhoods while strengthening our tax base.

Attracting High-Quality Employers

A strong economy begins with quality jobs.

I will support efforts that:

- Attract employers that provide stable, well-paying careers.
- Encourage innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Strengthen partnerships with educational institutions and workforce development organizations.
- Promote industries that diversify West Covina's economy.
- Support businesses that invest in our community and create long-term opportunities.

Supporting Entrepreneurship

Innovation begins with opportunity.

I will advocate for:

- Small business workshops and educational resources.

- Partnerships with local chambers of commerce and business organizations.
- Networking opportunities for entrepreneurs.
- Programs that encourage new business creation.
- Mentorship opportunities connecting experienced business owners with future entrepreneurs.

Working Regionally

West Covina does not exist in isolation.

Our success is strengthened when we collaborate with neighboring communities throughout the San Gabriel Valley.

I will work to:

- Build stronger regional partnerships.
- Promote economic development opportunities that benefit multiple communities.
- Share best practices with neighboring cities.
- Advocate for regional transportation and infrastructure improvements that support business growth.

Shopping Local Matters

Every dollar spent at a local business helps strengthen our community.

Supporting local restaurants, retailers, and service providers creates jobs, keeps investment within our community, and helps generate revenue that funds essential City services.

I will encourage initiatives that remind residents of the importance of shopping locally and supporting the businesses that have invested in West Covina.

Strong local businesses create strong neighborhoods.

Innovation Through Collaboration

Economic development is not simply about recruiting businesses.

It is about building relationships.

City government should be a partner—not an obstacle.

That means listening to employers, working collaboratively with property owners, encouraging responsible investment, and creating an environment where businesses feel welcomed rather than overwhelmed by bureaucracy.

Success comes when government and the private sector work together toward shared goals.

My Commitment

Economic opportunity should benefit every neighborhood.

Every family.

Every generation.

As your Councilmember, I will work to create an environment where businesses can grow, entrepreneurs can succeed, families can find

meaningful employment, and our City can continue investing in the services residents deserve.

I believe West Covina has tremendous potential.

With responsible leadership, thoughtful planning, and strong partnerships, we can revitalize commercial corridors, strengthen our local economy, and create opportunities that benefit both today's residents and future generations.

Our goal should not simply be economic growth.

Our goal should be **economic prosperity that improves the quality of life for every resident.**

Looking Ahead

A financially healthy city...

Safe neighborhoods...

Reliable infrastructure...

Beautiful parks...

And a thriving economy...

All depend on one thing:

Leadership that listens to its residents and works collaboratively to solve problems.

The final priority brings everything together.

It is about building a City Hall that earns the public's trust, values every resident's voice, and puts people—not politics—at the center of every decision.

That begins with **Priority Six: Community First.**